ORIGINAL ENTRY · WALKTHROUGH

Riverbend Bicycle Supply

Keeping the books for 2026-12-01 to 2026-12-15, on screen.

31 documents · 5 journals · 42 accounts · versions A, B, C

Your instruction booklet covers the accounting. This covers the software: what each screen is for, which steps are yours, and the two things the app works out for itself.

> **Nothing here happens on its own.** Entries are written, postings are posted, checkpoints are asked. The ledgers and the trial balance are the only things the app derives, and it derives them from what you posted.

The order of work

STEP 1

Documents

Read each one and decide whether it is a transaction to record. **Record an entry** marks that decision; it does not write the entry. Where a document needs nothing, choose **No entry required** and say why. That reason is part of the work and it is marked.

STEP 2

Journals

Pick the journal built for that kind of transaction, then enter the accounts and amounts.

STEP 3

Post

Move the entries to the ledgers yourself, to the general ledger and to the subsidiary ledgers where a line names a customer or a supplier. Nothing posts itself.

STEP 4

Ledgers

Derived from what you posted, so there is nothing to type. A balance that surprises you points at the entry or the posting behind it.

STEP 5

Trial balance

Also derived. If the columns do not agree, something is unposted or an entry carries a figure it should not.

STEP 6

Checkpoints

Test a figure you reached against the books you built.

STEP 7

Submit

Hands the books in and makes them read-only. Handed in by accident? Your instructor can give them back.

A worked example

This transaction is **not** one of your 31. It is here so every step can be shown in full without answering anything you are meant to judge yourself.

THE DOCUMENT

Cheque 9001, 3 December. Paid Marlow Window Cleaning $60.00 for cleaning the shop front.

1. On the document, say what it needs

It is a transaction, so choose **Record an entry**. That marks the decision and nothing more: no entry exists yet.

```
Documents › Cheque 9001
[ Record an entry ]  [ No entry required ]
```

2. Choose the journal

Money left the business by cheque, so it belongs in the **Cash Payments Journal**. Choosing the journal built for a transaction is part of what is marked.

3. Write the lines

Enter the accounts and the amounts. The app checks two mechanical things: that the entry balances, and that the journal has a column for each account you used. It says which of those failed and nothing else, because the accounts you chose are your judgement.

Account	Debit	Credit
Some expense account, as you judge it	60.00	
101 Cash		60.00

> **The app never names the account for you.** It is shown here as a blank on purpose; deciding it is the work.

4. Post it

Back in the journal, choose **Post to the general ledger**. Until you do, the entry sits in the journal and reaches no ledger and no trial balance. Where a line names a customer or a supplier, post it to the subsidiary ledger as well.

```
Journals › Cash Payments Journal
[ Post to the general ledger ]
```

5. Read the result

Cash in the general ledger is now $60.00 lower, and the trial balance has moved with it. You typed neither figure: both are worked out from the entry you posted.

The journals, and what each is for

Journal	Use it for
Sales Journal	Sales on account. Not cash sales.
Purchases Journal	Anything bought on account, from inventory to office supplies.
Cash Receipts Journal	Every receipt of money, including cash sales and payments from customers.
Cash Payments Journal	Every payment of money: cheques, remittances, payroll.
General Journal	Anything the four special journals have no column for.

A special journal has named columns, and it will refuse a line it has no column for. That refusal is about the journal, not about the account: the general journal takes anything.

Checkpoints

A checkpoint asks for one figure from your own books. Type what you reached and choose **Check**. It says whether your figure agrees with the books you built, and nothing about how you got there. Attempts are limited, so work it out before you try.

#	It asks for
1	Accounts Receivable control balance at 15 December
2	Cash balance at 15 December
3	Accounts Payable control balance at 15 December

What the app refuses, and why

You will see	It means
This entry does not balance	Debits and credits differ. Arithmetic, not judgement.
This journal has no column for that account	Either the account or the journal is not the one you want. Both are yours to decide.
These books are read-only	You submitted, or the deadline passed. Your instructor can give the books back.

A refusal is always mechanical. The app never comments on the accounts you chose or the figures you entered, and it never reacts differently to a mistake it was built to expect.

When you are stuck

Read the document again before changing an entry: most of what looks like a problem with the software is a detail on the paper, and the terms, the freight and the discount periods are all printed there. **Reference** in the workspace holds this company's chart of accounts. After that, ask your instructor, who can see where you are and what the app last refused.

> **Your figures are your own.** Riverbend Bicycle Supply comes in versions A, B, C, and they differ by design. A classmate's numbers will not match yours even where the method is identical.